HORIZON TECHX

HRM INTERNSHIP — TASK 2

BASIC HUMAN RESOURCE POLICY FOR A STARTUP

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1. Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this Human Resource (HR) Policy is to establish clear guidelines for leave management, professional conduct, and work-from-home arrangements within a startup organization.

This policy aims to maintain a professional, respectful, productive, and flexible work environment. It applies to employees, interns, and other team members, wherever relevant to their employment or internship terms.

All team members are expected to understand and follow these guidelines. The organization may revise this policy according to its operational requirements and applicable laws.

2. Leave Policy

2.1 Objective

The leave policy is designed to help team members manage personal needs while ensuring that business activities continue smoothly.

2.2 Types of Leave

The organization may provide the following categories of leave, subject to applicable laws, employment terms, and the company's approved leave rules:

- Casual Leave: For personal matters or urgent requirements.
- Sick Leave: For illness, medical appointments, or recovery.
- Annual or Earned Leave: For planned holidays, where applicable.
- Public Holidays: As announced by the organization.
- Emergency Leave: For unexpected personal or family emergencies.

The eligibility, duration, and availability of each leave category will be communicated by the organization.

2.3 Leave Application and Approval

1. Team members should submit planned leave requests to their reporting manager or HR department in advance.
2. The request should mention the proposed leave dates and a brief reason, where required.
3. Leave should be taken after approval, except in emergencies.
4. In case of sudden illness or an emergency, the team member should inform the manager or HR department as soon as reasonably possible.
5. Managers should review requests fairly, considering the individual's needs and business requirements.
6. Approved leave should be recorded in the organization's attendance or HR management system.

2.4 Leave Records and Responsibilities

HR is responsible for maintaining accurate leave records and communicating the applicable leave rules. Team members are responsible for submitting accurate requests and informing the relevant person about unexpected absences.

Unapproved or unexplained absences may be reviewed according to company procedures and applicable laws.

3. Code of Conduct

3.1 Professional Behaviour

Every team member must maintain professional behaviour while working with colleagues, managers, customers, clients, and business partners.

Employees and interns should communicate politely, cooperate with colleagues, respect different opinions, and contribute to a positive workplace culture.

3.2 Respect, Equality, and Workplace Safety

The organization expects all team members to treat one another with dignity and respect.

Discrimination, bullying, harassment, intimidation, and inappropriate behaviour are not acceptable. Concerns should be reported to HR or the designated reporting authority so that they can be handled appropriately and confidentially, to the extent possible.

3.3 Honesty and Integrity

Team members must perform their duties honestly and responsibly. They should provide accurate information, maintain truthful attendance and work records, and avoid misrepresentation of their qualifications, achievements, or work progress.

Any actual or potential conflict of interest should be disclosed to the appropriate manager or HR representative.

3.4 Confidentiality and Data Protection

Team members may have access to confidential business information, customer details, employee records, internal documents, or project information.

They must:

- Use confidential information only for authorized work.
- Avoid sharing sensitive information with unauthorized people.
- Protect passwords, accounts, documents, and company data.
- Follow the organization's data security procedures.
- Report suspected data loss, unauthorized access, or security incidents promptly.

Confidential information must not be used for personal benefit or disclosed without proper authorization.

3.5 Use of Company Property

Company equipment, software, accounts, documents, and other resources must be used responsibly and primarily for authorized business purposes.

Team members should protect company property from loss, damage, misuse, and unauthorized access. Any equipment issue or loss should be reported to the responsible person.

3.6 Attendance and Accountability

Team members should follow their assigned working hours, attend meetings on time, complete assigned tasks within agreed deadlines, and communicate delays promptly.

Managers should provide reasonable instructions and feedback. Employees and interns should take responsibility for their work and seek clarification when requirements are unclear.

3.7 Reporting Violations

Any suspected violation of this policy should be reported to HR or the designated manager. Reports should be reviewed fairly, with appropriate confidentiality and an opportunity for the concerned individuals to respond.

Corrective action, where necessary, should be proportionate and consistent with company procedures and applicable laws.

4. Work-from-Home (WFH) Guidelines

4.1 Purpose

Work-from-home arrangements may provide flexibility while supporting productivity and business continuity. Remote work is subject to the organization's approval and operational requirements.

4.2 Eligibility and Approval

1. Work-from-home arrangements must be approved by the reporting manager or authorized HR representative.
2. Team members should follow the approved remote-work schedule and any attendance requirements.
3. The organization may require employees or interns to work from the office when business needs, meetings, training, or other responsibilities require their presence.
4. Any change to an approved arrangement should be communicated and authorized in advance, where practicable.

4.3 Working Hours and Availability

Team members must follow their assigned working hours and remain reasonably available through approved communication channels.

They should attend scheduled online meetings, respond to work-related communications within reasonable timeframes, and inform their manager if they will be temporarily unavailable.

Personal breaks should be managed responsibly and in accordance with applicable working-hour rules.

4.4 Communication and Work Deliverables

Remote team members should maintain regular communication with their managers and colleagues.

They are expected to:

- Understand assigned tasks and deadlines.
- Provide progress updates when requested.
- Attend virtual meetings punctually.
- Submit work according to agreed timelines.
- Raise concerns or request support when facing difficulties.

Performance should be assessed using appropriate work outcomes, quality, responsibilities, and agreed expectations.

4.5 Workspace and Equipment

Team members should maintain a reasonably safe, quiet, and organized workspace that supports productive work.

They should use reliable internet access and authorized devices or software as required for their role. Equipment provided by the organization must be handled responsibly and used according to company instructions.

4.6 Information Security and Privacy

Team members must protect company information while working remotely. They should use authorized accounts and systems, secure their devices, avoid public or unsecured networks when accessing sensitive information, and prevent unauthorized individuals from viewing confidential material.

Company documents should not be stored on personal platforms or shared through unauthorized applications unless specifically permitted by the organization.

Any technical problem, suspected security incident, or loss of company equipment should be reported promptly.

4.7 Performance and Accountability

Working remotely does not remove professional responsibilities. Team members must complete assigned work, maintain communication, respect confidentiality, and follow the organization's policies.

Managers should communicate expectations clearly and provide appropriate feedback and support.

5. Policy Administration and Review

The HR department or designated management representative is responsible for communicating this policy, maintaining relevant records, and responding to policy-related questions.

All employees and interns should read the policy and seek clarification whenever necessary. The organization may review and update the policy when its operations, business requirements, or applicable laws change.

This document is a basic startup HR policy draft. The organization should customize it to reflect its actual leave entitlements, working arrangements, reporting procedures, and applicable legal requirements before formally implementing it.

End of Document

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